

Q: What is BIOMIS?

A: BIOMIS (Biodiversity Management Information System) is a web-enabled unique repository of biodiversity information developed by NIC (National Informatics Centre) for the Kerala State Biodiversity Board. It serves NBA, State Biodiversity Boards (SBB), Union Territory Biodiversity Councils (UTBC), Biodiversity Management Committees (BMC), and the public. It provides open and free access to biodiversity information and enables widespread participation by all citizens.

Q: What is the URL to access BIOMIS?

A: The BIOMIS portal can be accessed at www.biomis.kerala.gov.in. Enter your login ID, password, and captcha to sign in. The menu displayed will be based on your assigned role.

Q: What are the main objectives of BIOMIS?

A: The main objectives of BIOMIS are: to create a database for PBR by incorporating flora, fauna and associated knowledge for the state; to design and develop a web-based interface to update and process information at various official levels; to process and verify data updated by concerned officials; to generate reports in various formats for different levels of officials; to maintain a database of related maps and images; to provide state-level data consolidation for national-level requirements; and to provide a user-friendly search facility to browse PBR details.

Q: What are the key features of the BIOMIS portal?

A: BIOMIS digitizes biodiversity and traditional knowledge data, contains BMC member details and demographic information, allows citizens to capture and upload biodiversity pictures, enables submission of species sightings under the Observation menu, provides SBB/BMC conservation activity records, restricts confidential data from public access, supports role-based dashboards for each user level, provides 24x7 availability, has multiple-level security, and supports local language data entry.

Q: What is PBR?

A: PBR stands for People's Biodiversity Register. It is a comprehensive database recording people's traditional knowledge and insight of the status, uses, history, ongoing changes, and forces driving changes on the biological diversity resources of their localities. It provides information on current utilization patterns of biodiversity and its economic benefits to local communities. Biodiversity Boards prepare PBRs for each Local Self Government (LSG) body involving local communities.

Q: What is EPBR?

A: EPBR stands for Electronic People's Biodiversity Register. It is the digital version of the PBR created and managed within the BIOMIS portal. BMCs enter data across multiple EPBR tabs (General, BMC, Domain Knowledge Holder, Species, Pest Affecting Crop Details, Market Transaction Details, Land Scape, Soil Type, History, Civilization) to document local biodiversity information year-wise and panchayat-wise.

Q: What are the EPBR data entry tabs or sections?

A: The EPBR data entry form has the following tabs: General (geographical and

census details), BMC (committee profile and member details), Domain Knowledge Holder (traditional knowledge experts including Hakims and Vaidyans), Species (flora and fauna details), Pest Affecting Crop Details, Market Transaction Details, Land Landscape, Soil Type, History (historical and cultural information), and Civilization (demographic and livelihood details). All tabs must be completed before submission.

Q: What is NBA?

A: NBA stands for National Biodiversity Authority. It is the apex body managing biodiversity governance in India. In BIOMIS, the NBA Super Admin manages the system at the national level, maintains master data, manages the master species database provided by ZSI and BSI, oversees system governance, and supervises Access and Benefit Sharing mechanisms.

Q: What is SBB?

A: SBB stands for State Biodiversity Board. It is the state-level biodiversity governance body. In BIOMIS, SBB enters state-specific data (soil, vegetation, geoscape, land use), constitutes Verification Officers, reviews and approves EPBR submissions, and publishes the final EPBR. SBB is the primary approving authority at the state level.

Q: What is UTBC?

A: UTBC stands for Union Territory Biodiversity Council. It is the Union Territory-level equivalent of the State Biodiversity Board (SBB) and performs all the same functions within its jurisdiction including verification, approval, and publication of EPBRs.

Q: What is a BMC?

A: BMC stands for Biodiversity Management Committee. It is the grassroots local body and core data-contributing entity in BIOMIS. BMCs are created at the panchayat, municipality, or corporation level. They feed data into the EPBR tabs, document biological resources and traditional knowledge, and identify benefit claimers. BMC users can only enter data for the panchayat assigned to them during user creation.

Q: What is TSG?

A: TSG stands for Technical Support Group. It is a group of technical experts who assist BMCs during EPBR data entry. If a BMC user needs help filling in the EPBR tabs, they can contact their assigned TSG or District Admin.

Q: What is ABS?

A: ABS stands for Access and Benefit Sharing. It is a framework to ensure that communities who are custodians of biological resources receive fair benefits when those resources are accessed or used commercially. Once the EPBR is published, it is linked to the ABS framework.

Q: What is the role of ZSI and BSI in BIOMIS?

A: ZSI (Zoological Survey of India) and BSI (Botanical Survey of India) provide the master species database to the NBA Super Admin. They also constitute Verification Officers who scientifically validate the EPBR data submitted by BMCs.

Q: Who is a Verification Officer?

A: A Verification Officer is an expert constituted by SBB/UTBC, typically from ZSI, BSI, or other institutions, who scientifically validates the EPBR data submitted by BMCs. After a BMC submits data, the Verification Officer reviews and assesses the actual data against the submitted application. If valid, data is forwarded to SBB/UTBC. If not valid, it is returned to the BMC with remarks for correction.

Q: Who is a Benefit Claimer?

A: A Benefit Claimer is a community or individual who is the custodian of biological resources and associated traditional knowledge. BMCs identify benefit claimers as part of the EPBR data entry process.

Q: What are the user roles in BIOMIS?

A: BIOMIS has the following user roles: (1) NBA Super Admin – national-level system management and master data; (2) SBB/UTBC – state-level data entry, verification management, approval and publication; (3) District Admin – creates and manages BMCs and coordinates EPBR submission; (4) District Verification Officer – verifies year-wise e-PBR; (5) District Approving Officer – approves year-wise e-PBR; (6) BMC User – enters year-wise EPBR data and data collection agency details; (7) Public – can search biodiversity information on the portal.

Q: What is the role of the NBA Super Admin?

A: The NBA Super Admin manages the system at the national level, handles and maintains master data, manages the master species database provided by ZSI and BSI, oversees overall system governance, and supervises ABS mechanisms. Master data created by the NBA Super Admin forms the foundation for all state and district-level entries.

Q: What is the role of the District Admin?

A: The District Admin creates BMCs (Biodiversity Management Committees), creates and manages BMC user accounts, coordinates EPBR data submission from BMCs, and ensures smooth onboarding and management of local bodies. District Admins can also manage master data at the district level.

Q: What is the role of the SBB or UTBC in BIOMIS?

A: SBB/UTBC enters state-specific data such as soil, vegetation, geoscape, and land use details. They enter local names corresponding to master species data, constitute Verification Officers, review and approve EPBR submissions, and publish the final EPBR. They are the primary approving authority at the state level.

Q: What is the full EPBR workflow?

A: The EPBR workflow has 6 steps. Step 1 – Data Entry: BMC enters data across all EPBR tabs year-wise; TSG may assist. Step 2 – Submission: BMC officer submits the completed data. Step 3 – Verification: Data moves digitally to the Verification Officer who validates it against actual ground data. Step 4 – Validation Outcome: If not valid, data is returned to BMC with remarks for correction and resubmission. If valid, data is forwarded to SBB/UTBC. Step 5 – Approval: SBB/UTBC reviews and approves. EPBR is placed before the BMC Meeting for formal approval. Once approved, the system generates the EPBR Report and Certificate. Step 6 – Publication: SBB/UTBC publishes the final EPBR and links it to the ABS framework.

Q: What happens after a BMC submits EPBR data?

A: After submission, the data moves digitally through the workflow to the Verification Officer. The Verification Officer reviews the data. If valid, it is forwarded to SBB/UTBC for approval. If not valid, it is returned to the BMC with remarks for corrections.

Q: What happens after the Verification Officer validates EPBR data?

A: If the data is valid, it is forwarded to SBB/UTBC for review and approval. The SBB/UTBC then approves it and places it before the BMC Meeting for formal approval. After both approvals, the system generates the EPBR Report and Certificate.

Q: How is the EPBR certificate generated?

A: After SBB/UTBC approval and BMC Meeting approval, the system automatically generates the EPBR Report and Certificate as per Rule 22(10) of the Biological Diversity Rules 2004. The certificate is endorsed with resolution number and date, signed by the BMC Chairman, BMC Secretary, counter-signed by a representative of NGO or organization involved in the PBR exercise, and counter-signed by the Member Secretary of SBB or authorized official of SBB.

Q: Who approves the EPBR?

A: The SBB/UTBC is the primary approving authority. After the Verification Officer validates the data, the SBB/UTBC reviews and approves it. This is followed by formal BMC Meeting approval. Both approvals are required before the certificate is generated.

Q: Who publishes the EPBR?

A: The SBB/UTBC publishes the final approved EPBR after validation by the Verification Officer, approval by SBB/UTBC, and formal approval at the BMC Meeting.

Q: How do I login to BIOMIS portal?

A: Go to www.biomis.kerala.gov.in. Enter your registered user ID, password, and the captcha shown on screen. Click Login. After successful login, you will get a role-based dashboard based on your assigned role. If you have forgotten your password, use the Forgot Password option to reset it via your registered email or mobile number.

Q: I cannot login to BIOMIS. What should I do?

A: First check if Caps Lock is on. Make sure you are entering the correct user ID and password. Use the Forgot Password option if you have forgotten your password. If your account is locked or you have not received credentials, contact your District Admin (for BMC users) or your SBB (for District Admins). If there is a technical issue, report it to your Nodal Officer or the NIC coordinator.

Q: Who do I contact for new user account creation?

A: BMC users should contact their District Admin. District Admins should contact their SBB/UTBC. SBB/UTBC users should contact the NBA Super Admin.

Q: How do I create a new BMC?

A: Only District Admins can create BMCs. Login as District Admin, go to BMC Management, and create a new BMC with the required details and user accounts. Each BMC is assigned to a specific panchayat, municipality, or corporation.

Q: How do I enter EPBR data as a BMC user?

A: Login with your BMC credentials. You will see a role-based dashboard showing the status of PBR applications, activities, and new findings. Navigate to the EPBR option in the menu. The system will display your panchayat details based on your assigned role. Fill in data across all the EPBR tabs (General, BMC, Domain Knowledge Holder, Species, Pest, Market, Land Landscape, Soil Type, History, Civilization) for the current year. After completing all tabs, submit the data. Contact your TSG or District Admin for help with specific fields.

Q: What is the General tab in EPBR?

A: The General tab captures the basic geographical and demographic data of the panchayat including: geographical area, census data (population by male, female, transgender, total), climate information, landscape type, habitat and topography details, and management regime. This is the first tab to fill in the EPBR form.

Q: What is the BMC tab in EPBR?

A: The BMC tab captures the profile details of the Biodiversity Management Committee including: BMC name (in English and local language), constituted date, start date, validity period, email, bank account number, bank name, branch, and BMC member details such as name, designation, communication address, and contact information.

Q: What is the Domain Knowledge Holder tab in EPBR?

A: The Domain Knowledge Holder tab documents traditional knowledge experts in the panchayat. It captures: name, age, occupation, gender, communication address, area of specialization, domain type (Hakim, Vaidyan, or other), location from which the person accesses biological material, and remarks. This includes traditional healers, Hakims, and Vaidyans.

Q: What is the Species tab in EPBR?

A: The Species tab captures detailed information about flora and fauna found in the panchayat. Fields include: biodiversity type (flora or fauna), species category, habitat, agronomic group, growth habit, scientific name, wild local name, local name (in English and local language), variety, landscape/habitat, crop area, crop status (present and past), cropping season, special features, use/other details, associated traditional knowledge, source of seeds, community knowledge holder, tribal/non-tribal classification, user group, and whether the species is economically important. Images can also be uploaded.

Q: What is the Pest Affecting Crop Details tab in EPBR?

A: The Pest Affecting Crop Details tab captures information about pests that affect crops in the panchayat. It records: biodiversity type, species, habitat, agronomic group, growth habit, scientific name, local name, season of attack, management mechanism (traditional pest control methods), community knowledge holder, affected crop details, habitat details, ward, and other knowledge.

Q: What is the Market Transaction Details tab in EPBR?

A: The Market Transaction Details tab captures biodiversity-related market activity. It records: biodiversity type, market name, market frequency type, market sale category, quantity brought, quantity sold, quantity transported, places from which brought, and remarks. This helps document the commercial value and trade of biodiversity resources.

Q: What is the Land Landscape tab in EPBR?

A: The Land Landscape tab captures landscape-level biodiversity information. It records: biodiversity type, major landscape, sub landscape, local name of land, ownership details, user group, management practices, general uses, associated traditional knowledge, availability of minerals, area of mineral availability, type of pollution, source of pollution, extent, community access details, and plant/animal details for each landscape unit.

Q: What is the Soil Type tab in EPBR?

A: The Soil Type tab captures soil characteristics and associated biodiversity. It records: biodiversity type, agronomic group, soil type, soil texture, color features, management details (e.g., mud bank), associated traditional knowledge (e.g., cultivation practices, fertility), and plant/animal details that live in the soil.

Q: What is the History tab in EPBR?

A: The History tab captures historical and cultural information about the panchayat. It records history names, historical details, and images of historical significance. This includes information about historical events, cultural heritage, and traditionally important places or practices in the locality.

Q: What is the Civilization tab in EPBR?

A: The Civilization tab captures demographic and livelihood information about the communities in the panchayat. It records: population count by occupation, religion, social status (forward/backward/tribal), other earning jobs, major dependent resources, landscape management practices, nature of inhabitants, family member count, and resource management practices.

Q: My EPBR data was returned for correction. What do I do?

A: Your Verification Officer found issues in the submitted data. Login to BIOMIS and check the remarks or feedback provided by the Verification Officer. Navigate to the EPBR section, make the necessary corrections in the relevant tabs, and resubmit the data.

Q: What is the BMC Activity Achievement section?

A: The BMC Activity Achievement section allows BMC admins to record the activities and achievements of the BMC. It captures: BMC activity, BMC sub-activity, year, month, unit, physical achievement, financial achievement, allotted fund, balance fund, and remarks. Multiple images can be uploaded using the Add More button. This documents conservation activities carried out by the BMC.

Q: What is the Data Collection section in BIOMIS?

A: The Data Collection section manages the agencies that collect biodiversity data in the field. It has three sub-sections: (1) Agency Details – records the name, type, address, and email of data collection agencies (NGOs, government bodies,

research institutions, colleges, schools, universities, or individuals); (2) Agency Member Details – records details of individual members of the agency; (3) Agency Study Details – records ward-wise study assignments, start and end dates, and member roles for each study area.

Q: What types of agencies can be registered for data collection in BIOMIS?

A: The following agency types can register for data collection: NGO, Government bodies, Research Institutions, Colleges, Schools, Universities, and Individuals. The BMC admin enters the collected data into the portal after field collection.

Q: How do I update work completion details for an agency?

A: Login as BMC user, go to Data Collection and select Update Work Details. Select the agency name from the dropdown, and the system will display the assigned work details. Enter the Actual Completion Date for the study in the particular ward/area and add remarks. Save the record.

Q: How do I submit species sightings on BIOMIS?

A: Login to the BIOMIS portal and go to the Observation menu. You can submit your species sightings there with photos and location details.

Q: How do I upload a biodiversity photo?

A: After logging in to BIOMIS, go to the Observation or Upload section. Capture or select the photo and upload it. The photo will appear in the respective BMC's dashboard.

Q: Can citizens contribute to BIOMIS?

A: Yes. Citizens can submit species sightings under the Observation menu, capture and upload pictures of biodiversity which appear in the respective BMC dashboard, and access open biodiversity information freely on the portal. A public feedback form is also available for citizens to send messages to the system administrator.

Q: Is all data on BIOMIS publicly available?

A: No. Confidential data is restricted and not available to the public. Only non-confidential biodiversity information is open and freely accessible. Sensitive traditional knowledge and restricted species data are protected.

Q: What are the main menu items on the BIOMIS home page?

A: The main menu items on the BIOMIS home page are: (1) Home, (2) About, (3) E-Services, (4) Search, (5) Observation, (6) Reports, (7) Downloads, (8) Feedback, (9) Contact Us, and (10) Help.

Q: How do I use the Search feature in BIOMIS?

A: The Search feature allows users to search biodiversity resources and e-PBR master data. You can search for: (1) Availability of Species – view species by habitat, agronomic group, local body type; you can view species image, details, and occurrences by panchayat; (2) Generic Species – search by species type, agronomic group, family, status, scientific name; (3) Synonyms – search species synonyms; (4) Traditional Vaidyans – search domain knowledge holders; (5) Hakims – search traditional medicine practitioners; (6) e-PBR – search year-wise approved e-PBR details and download PDF reports.

Q: How do I view approved e-PBR details?

A: Go to Search in the menu, select e-PBR. Select the State, District, Local body Type, Block, LSG Details, and Year. Click Search. The results will display with options to view PDF (full report), View (year-wise details), or Print (certificate).

Q: How do I generate an e-PBR report?

A: Go to Reports in the menu, select e-PBR. Select the State, District, Local body Type, Block, LSG Details, and Year. The system will display the e-PBR summary. Click PDF to download the full year-wise e-PBR report. Click View to see the details. Click Print to generate the certificate.

Q: What is the AgencyWise Study Area Details report?

A: The AgencyWise Study Area Details report shows the wards and areas covered by each data collection agency. It displays agency type, agency name, start date, end date, wards covered, and the View/PDF options. The PDF shows full agency details, data collection area, and member information.

Q: What is the AgencyWise Work Completion Details report?

A: The AgencyWise Work Completion Details report shows the work status (completed, pending, delayed, advance) of each agency by ward. It displays the state, district, local body, ward number, work start date, work completion date, actual completion date, and performance status (Delayed/Advance/On Time).

Q: How do I submit a feedback or complaint in BIOMIS?

A: On the home page, click Feedback. Fill in the feedback form with: Name, Email ID, Mobile Number, Type of Issue, Description, and Captcha. Click Send to submit the feedback to the System Administrator. To check the status of a submitted feedback, go to Feedback and click View. Enter your Feedback ID and Mobile Number to view the reply status.

Q: How do I change my password in BIOMIS?

A: After logging in, go to the Change Password option (usually under your profile or settings menu). Enter your Current Password, New Password, and Confirm Password. Save the changes. If you cannot remember your current password, use the Forgot Password option on the login page.

Q: What are the hardware and software requirements for BIOMIS?

A: BIOMIS requires a PC or smart mobile device with internet connectivity. Any modern web browser can be used to access the portal. If local language data is not displayed properly, you may need to download and install a local language Unicode font from the portal.

Q: How do I report a technical problem in BIOMIS?

A: Technical problems should be reported to the Nodal Officer of the concerned department or the concerned District NIC officer, who will forward it to the State Coordinator. Problems can also be reported through the Online Help option or by emailing the NIC coordinator. When reporting, include: your user level (Data Entry/Verification/Approval/Administration), name of the option where the problem occurred, description of the error message, and a screenshot (press PrtScn button and paste into a file for upload).

Q: What does the role-based dashboard show in BIOMIS?

A: Each user level in BIOMIS has a role-based dashboard. The BMC dashboard shows the status of PBR applications, BMC activities, and new findings observed in the panchayat. Other dashboards show information relevant to the user's role such as pending verifications for Verification Officers, pending approvals for Approval Officers, and district-wide statistics for District Admins.

Q: What are the general interface instructions for BIOMIS?

A: The BIOMIS interface has common features: (1) Pagination – default is 10 records per page; you can change to 15, 20, or 25 records; (2) Search/Filter – filter the grid by entering search criteria; (3) Save – saves data and shows "Successfully Inserted" message; (4) Edit – click the Edit button on any row to modify data, then Save or Exit; (5) Inactive/Delete – click the Inactive (delete) icon to remove a record; the system prompts for confirmation; (6) Exit – goes back to the previous screen without saving.

Q: How do I contact Kerala State Biodiversity Board?

A: Kerala State Biodiversity Board can be contacted at: Address – Jai Nagar, Krishna Villa, Kuravankonam, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala 695001. Email: ksbiodiversity@gmail.com. The BIOMIS portal was developed and is maintained by NIC (National Informatics Centre), Kerala State Unit, Ministry of Communications and Information Technology, Government of India.

Q: What is the e-Alert feature in BIOMIS?

A: BIOMIS has two types of alerts: (1) Internal Alert – used to provide intimations to department users within the system; (2) External Alert – used to provide messages or notifications to citizens visiting the portal.

Q: What is the full hierarchy in BIOMIS?

A: The full hierarchy in BIOMIS is: NBA Super Admin (national level) → SBB/UTBC (state level) → District Admin (district level) → BMC (grassroots/panchayat level). Data flows from BMC upward through verification by the Verification Officer and approval by SBB/UTBC before being published.

Q: What information is captured in the e-PBR report?

A: The e-PBR report includes: (1) General Details – geographical area, population, land landscape, climate, habitat and topography; (2) BMC Details – committee name, constitution, members; (3) Domain Knowledge Holder – traditional knowledge experts with their areas of specialization; (4) Species – flora and fauna with scientific names, local names, uses, traditional knowledge; (5) Pest – pest species, season of attack, management mechanisms; (6) Market Transactions – market names, quantities traded; (7) Land Landscape – landscape types, ownership, management practices; (8) Crop Best Suited for Soil; (9) History and Civilization details.

Q: What is ABS and how does it relate to EPBR?

A: ABS stands for Access and Benefit Sharing. Once the EPBR is published, it is linked to the ABS framework to ensure that communities who are custodians of biological resources receive fair benefits when those resources are accessed or used commercially. The NBA Super Admin oversees the ABS mechanism at the national level.

Q: What does master data in BIOMIS include?

A: Master data is created and maintained by the NBA Super Admin at the national level. It includes the master species database provided by ZSI and BSI, local body types, district and state data, agency types, and other system-wide reference data. This master data forms the foundation for all state and district-level entries. SBB can enter local names corresponding to master species data.

Q: What is the scope of BIOMIS?

A: BIOMIS covers the entire state of Kerala capturing biodiversity details from local bodies including Grama Panchayat, Block Panchayat, Municipality, and Corporation. It introduces m-Governance with Responsive Web Design (RWD) technology to enable anywhere and any-device service delivery. It also provides a facility for online reporting of new biodiversity findings.